fact that the TTP's plan to attack the nuclear site in Dera Ghazi Khan (Punjab-bordering Balochistan province) came to light, which alarmed the security forces. The target could be a key military and civilian fuel cycle site located about 40 km from DG Khan (*Express Tribune*, 2012).

Asmatullah Muavia was the head of TTP Punjab, who conducted a series of terrorist activities in KP and Punjab for a number of years. However, after the military operation 'Zarb-e-Azb' was launched in North Waziristan in 2014, he announced to call off armed struggle in Pakistan (*Dawn*, 2014). He gave mixed statements that they would only indulge in *Tabligh* (preaching) in Pakistan but their activities inside Afghanistan would continue. It was not known on what terms and conditions the military pardoned him for the terrorist activities Punjabi Taliban had carried out under his command. When the newly elected government of Nawaz Sharif initiated its efforts to negotiate with the TTP, the Punjabi Taliban became increasingly open to peace talks with the government, which was the reason the main leadership parted ways with them.

TTP'S TACTICS AND TARGETS

The TTP had been carrying out insurgency in its strongholds of Waziristan and Swat and terrorism in urban centres of Pakistan. Its two-pronged strategy aimed at establishing its writ in the insurgency hit areas and to keep the government demoralised through suicide attacks in the cities.

Insurgency

There is an appreciable overlap between many of the insurgent movements and terrorist organisations. Taliban would be considered as both an insurgent and terrorist organisation.

Insurgency is generally the origin of terrorist attacks in areas and population centres that fall out of the domain of insurgents. It is done to either draw attention to the cause or reaction to counter-insurgency measures or both. The TTP falls in the same category of an insurgent and terrorist organisation.

In line with the definition of insurgency, 'the organised use of subversion and violence to seize, nullify, or challenge political control of